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**INTERNAL ONLY : FW: TF AEM Migration Approach Discussion Requested**

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**From** Sajesh Enampurath <senampurath@adobe.com>

**Date** Tue 5/26/2026 11:13 AM

**To** Deepti Baijal <dbaijal@adobe.com>

**Cc** Priya Singh <priyasingh@adobe.com>; Rob Rusher <rrusher@adobe.com>; Ramandeep Harjai <harjai@adobe.com>; Dusty Garner <garnerca@adobe.com>

Hi Deepti,

We need to add additional information to the Use cases document :  [TFS-UseCases.xlsx](#)

Can you please add two columns to this document to capture two sets of important information per Dusty's email below ?

- A clear, side-by-side comparison of DA Live vs. AEM JCR on AEM Cloud with EDS — capabilities, trade-offs, operational impacts, and governance implications specific to Thermo Fisher's environment.
- Critical Change managements steps : Change in process for TFS team against each use case that reflects the areas of governance, authoring process, workflows etc.

I am on PTO tomorrow 5/26, so Dusty will expand more on this. But meanwhile can you please start collecting this information or have questions ready for tomorrow's daily sync ?

Thanks,

**Sajesh Enampurath** | Senior Project Manager | **Adobe** | C 415 572 1110 | [senampurath@adobe.com](mailto:senampurath@adobe.com)

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**From:** Dusty Garner <garnerca@adobe.com>

**Sent:** Friday, May 22, 2026 1:05 PM

**To:** Caputo, Michael <michael.caputo@thermofisher.com>; Sajesh Enampurath <senampurath@adobe.com>; Guy Carter <gcarter@adobe.com>

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**Subject:** Re: TF AEM Migration Approach Discussion Requested

Mike —

Thank you for this and your time today. I want to start by apologizing for not sending an email acknowledgement over sooner saying: this is exactly the kind of feedback a good partner should share, and we're glad you did. The level of detail and internal alignment behind this email tells us your team has thought seriously about what a right-fit recommendation actually needs to look like for Thermo Fisher. We take that seriously too.

The concerns you've outlined are valid. Several of them reflect gaps in how we've communicated our recommendation to date, and a few surface questions we need to answer

more rigorously before the SDD readout. We are going to strive to meet that request. What I can commit to is that we will address these substantively.

Here is our plan.

### **What you'll see in either the SDD or other means on May 28**

The session on May 28 will be structured to directly address the framework you've outlined. Specifically:

- A clear, side-by-side comparison of DA Live vs. AEM JCR on AEM Cloud with EDS — capabilities, trade-offs, operational impacts, and governance implications specific to Thermo Fisher's environment.
- An honest assessment of DA Live at your scale. Your MSM configuration, 140+ country sites, 200+ content authors, and complex inheritance model is not a standard deployment. The SDD will address how DA Live performs in that context specifically — including where constraints exist and what the mitigation or trade-off is.
- Direct answers on the maturity question. Where functionality is still in development or dependent on roadmap items, we will say so clearly rather than assume it away.
- Workflow and governance impact documentation for each use case — authoring model, inheritance behavior, rollout and synchronization, approval workflows, and governance controls under each approach.
- Transparent change management and operational burden assessment — training, intake, publishing model, and regional team impact.

### **What we are not in a position to do by May 28**

I want to be equally direct here. Some of the items you've raised — particularly a pilot implementation, full MSM inheritance demonstration, and regional content management validation — are not something we can deliver within the current SDD scope and timeline. Those are legitimate asks and we want to discuss how they fit into the engagement going forward. We'll come to the May 28 session prepared to have that conversation.

### **Client References**

We hear you on the early adopter concern and we take it seriously. We have two customer references in process and are expecting confirmation early next week - things are just delayed for the summer holidays. Once finalized, we will schedule those conversations as a priority. We've briefed our reference team on your specific areas of focus: enterprise-scale MSM complexity, authoring workflow change, and governance in production.

We value this partnership and we're committed to getting this recommendation right for Thermo Fisher — not just technically, but operationally. More to come.

**Dusty Garner** (they/them) | **Principal Engagement Executive** | **Adobe** | C 513 560-8763 | [garnerca@adobe.com](mailto:garnerca@adobe.com)

[Book time with Dusty Garner](#)

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**From:** Caputo, Michael <[michael.caputo@thermofisher.com](mailto:michael.caputo@thermofisher.com)>

**Date:** Wednesday, May 20, 2026 at 5:01 PM

**To:** Sajesh Enampurath <[senampurath@adobe.com](mailto:senampurath@adobe.com)>; Dusty Garner <[garnerca@adobe.com](mailto:garnerca@adobe.com)>; Guy Carter <[gcarter@adobe.com](mailto:gcarter@adobe.com)>

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**Subject:** TF AEM Migration Approach Discussion Requested

**EXTERNAL: Use caution when clicking on links or opening attachments.**

Adobe Team,

Ahead of next week's Solution Design Document (SDD) readout and recommendation session, we wanted to share some feedback and alignment from our internal stakeholder discussions to ensure we are entering the conversation with clear expectations and a shared understanding of what Thermo Fisher is looking for from this engagement. We are requesting a meeting to discuss with the team on this email by the end of this week, since Keith will be out next week, we don't want to delay.

First, we appreciate the time and effort the Adobe team has invested throughout discovery and the initial SDD review process. We value this partnership and want to ensure the recommendations presented are grounded in what is truly best for ThermoFisher.com from both a technical and operational perspective.

As we have communicated throughout the engagement, our team is not yet fully sold on Adobe DA Live as the sole or assumed direction for our future-state architecture. While we understand Adobe's enthusiasm around DA Live and recognize its potential benefits, our expectation is that all viable options remain objectively evaluated and, on the table, including but not limited to: AEM JCR on AEM Cloud with EDS, Adobe DA live with EDS.

Our internal team met this morning and is fully aligned that we need a balanced recommendation framework that clearly outlines the pros, cons, risks, operational impacts, governance implications, authoring experience considerations, scalability, and long-term sustainability of each approach.

A key concern for us is ensuring we are not simply optimizing for the easiest technical migration path while unintentionally shifting significant complexity and operational burden onto governance, training, intake management, and content authoring teams post-implementation.

Thermo Fisher operates at significant scale. As a centralized corporate web team, we support hundreds of web requests daily, in addition to supporting approximately 200 content authors across the organization. Any recommendation that materially changes authoring workflows, governance processes, intake structures, publishing models, or training requirements will have substantial organizational and operational implications that must be fully understood and planned for in advance.

If Adobe ultimately recommends DA Live as the preferred path, we need:

- Clear and well-documented reasoning behind that recommendation
- Transparent comparisons against alternative approaches
- A detailed understanding of the organizational impact
- Visibility into governance and operational tradeoffs

- Realistic expectations around change management, enablement, training, and adoption efforts
- An understanding of how workflows and intake processes would need to evolve to align with the platform's capabilities and constraints

We want to ensure the recommendation is being driven by what is genuinely the best fit for Thermo Fisher's business model, governance structure, scale, and operating realities, not simply because DA Live is the newest offering or because it simplifies aspects of the technical upgrade effort.

To be candid, there is also some concern internally that Thermo Fisher may effectively become an early large-scale adopter or "guinea pig" for DA Live within a highly complex enterprise environment. That naturally increases our need for diligence, transparency, supporting evidence, and clear articulation of both benefits and risks.

Our expectation from Adobe as our partner is not advocacy for a single predefined outcome, but rather thoughtful guidance that helps us make an informed enterprise decision with full visibility into the tradeoffs involved.

Below is a detailed list of the areas where we need additional clarification and discussion:

- **Lack of clarity on the practical differences between AEM DA and AEM JCR approaches**
  - We still do not feel we have received a clear side-by-side comparison of DA vs JCR capabilities, tradeoffs, implementation implications, and operational impacts specific to Thermo Fisher's environment.
  - The current recommendation appears heavily weighted toward DA without sufficient detail on what functionality or workflows would differ under a JCR-based approach.
- **Uncertainty around why DA is being recommended over AEM JCR**
  - We would like clarification on whether DA is being recommended because:
    - AEM JCR technically cannot support our MSM hierarchy and use cases, or
    - Adobe's long-term product investment roadmap is simply focused on DA going forward.
  - Our understanding is that an AEM JCR backend should still technically support our existing MSM structure with Edge Delivery Services and Universal Editor overlays.
- **Concerns regarding maturity and readiness of the DA platform**
  - Several of the proposed capabilities appear to still be under active development.
  - Adobe indicated that certain required MSM-related functionality would need future product enhancements before becoming available out-of-the-box.
  - This creates uncertainty around implementation timelines, delivery risk, and dependency on unreleased functionality.
- **Significant concerns around loss of component-level inheritance**
  - Our current operating model relies heavily on component-level inheritance and localized component overrides.
  - The proposed DA model appears to require breaking inheritance at the page level rather than component level.
  - We need detailed examples and demonstrations showing:
    - How migrated pages would behave when only component-level inheritance exists today.
    - What the resulting authoring model would look like post-migration.
    - How synchronization and rollout behaviors would function in practice.

- **Potential increase in authoring overhead and operational complexity**

- The team is concerned that the proposed inheritance model could significantly increase content maintenance effort.
- There is uncertainty around whether localized changes would require managing multiple disconnected page variations rather than controlled component-level overrides.
- We need better understanding of the long-term operational burden on content authors and regional teams.

- **Lack of clarity around rollout and MSM behavior in DA**

- It remains unclear how multi-level rollouts, country inheritance, regional variations, and selective synchronization will function in DA.
- Questions remain regarding:
  - Whether rollout operations will cascade automatically through hierarchy levels.
  - How non-MSM countries and regional structures would be managed.
  - Whether additional manual rollout operations would be required.

- **Governance and workflow concerns**

- We have concerns regarding how governance controls currently enforced through templates, inheritance structures, and component architecture will function in DA.
- We need additional detail around:
  - Activation workflows
  - Content governance models
  - Approval workflows
  - Template enforcement
  - Guardrails and validation mechanisms
  - “Pre-flight” governance capabilities referenced during discussions

- **Universal Editor capability gaps and readiness concerns**

- While Universal Editor overlays are being discussed for DA, it remains unclear whether the functionality is equivalent to current AEM authoring capabilities.
- We need clearer documentation regarding:
  - What can and cannot currently be done in Universal Editor with DA.
  - Differences between Universal Editor on DA vs Universal Editor with AEM JCR backend.
  - Current feature limitations and roadmap timing.

- **Need for detailed migration strategy and resource planning**

- We need significantly more detail regarding:
  - Migration sequencing
  - Resource requirements
  - MSM node migration handling
  - Redirect handling
  - Technical debt carryover
  - Country and region setup requirements
  - Expected operational effort during migration

- **Concern that Thermo Fisher may become an early adopter / “test case”**

- Multiple team members expressed concern that Thermo Fisher may be among the first enterprise clients implementing this level of MSM complexity on DA.
- We need transparency around:
  - Existing customer references
  - Proven enterprise implementations
  - Production-scale examples comparable to our use case

- Lessons learned from other deployments
- **Request for customer references and implementation examples**
  - We would appreciate the opportunity to speak directly with customers currently using DA in enterprise-scale implementations, particularly where Universal Editor overlays and complex MSM-like requirements exist.
- **Need for pilot/testing approach before final commitment**
  - Given the scale of workflow and governance changes implied by DA, we believe a pilot implementation will be necessary before finalizing migration direction.
  - This should include:
    - Migration of representative page sets
    - Testing of authoring workflows
    - Governance validation
    - Rollout/inheritance testing
    - Regional content management scenarios
    - Operational support model validation
- **Potential impact to SOW, timeline, and scope**
  - We believe the above concerns could materially impact implementation scope, delivery approach, timeline, and associated SOW assumptions.
  - We would like to discuss these topics collaboratively before the final recommendation and SOW are finalized.

Thanks

Michal Caputo  
Staff Program Manager  
Digital Commerce Platforms